CHRISTCHURCH HITCHIN

TRUSTEES' ANNUAL REPORT

and

STATEMENT OF FINANCIAL ACTIVITY

Year to 31 August 2014

Trustees' Report 2013-14

Trustees have the duty and responsibility to report on the activities of the Charity that is Christchurch (Methodist and United Reformed) Church, Hitchin located at Bedford Road, Hitchin, SG5 1HF. It is a registered charity, no. 1142830, and its constitution was formally approved in 2010. Correspondence can be addressed to the Church Secretary at that address.

The Trustees consist of the Minister, the Deacon and 13 persons elected from and by the church's members in accordance with the terms of the constitution for a fixed term. Those serving throughout the year 2013-14 were as follows:

Rev. John Hardaker, Deacon Sheralee Devitt, Sara Crowley, Shirley Rossall, Chris Blackman, Peter Ward, Sue Covington, Jeremy Rackham, Rob Bryan, David Rossall

Retired during the year:

Nora Evans, Sue Chastney, Katherine Harris, Bernard Higgs, Robin Meyers

Elected during the year:

Christine Warren, Anne Blackman, Mandy Pye

A vacancy for Steward remained unfilled during the year.

The Trustees, normally called the Leadership Group, meet at least 5 times each year, and have overall responsibility for all aspects of Church Life.

Objectives and Activities

The Trustees are committed to develop the work of the charity, to strengthen the discipleship of its members and to support and encourage others to develop their faith and make a commitment as a follower of Christ.

The Church's Mission Statement is: ***Led by the Spirit – Working in the Community – Bringing people to Christ***.

The Purpose of the Charity, as set out in the Christchurch constitution, is to advance the Christian faith in the Area of Benefit in accordance with the principles and practices of the Methodist and United Reformed Churches.

The Trustees have a duty under the constitution to give the necessary direction to achieve its Purpose, and to:

> "engage in a range of activities, either on its own or with others, including (but not restricted to):
>
> a. the celebration of public worship;
> b. the teaching of the Christian faith;
> c. mission and evangelism;
> d. pastoral work, including visiting the sick and the bereaved;
> e. the provision of facilities with a Christian ethos for the local community, including (but not restricted to) the elderly, the young and other groups with special needs; and
> f. the support of other charities in the UK and overseas. "

The Trustees wish to report that they have endeavoured to comply with the Church's Purpose as described below:

(a) Celebration of public worship

Worship is a key activity of any church to enable people to express praise and thanks, to draw closer to God, and be open to the work of the Holy Spirit. We worship privately and corporately, in small and large groups. We celebrate God's presence in the world and seek to magnify that presence with our lives. For many this provides an essential foundation for all other activities.

Gathered worship at Christchurch has great variety. We provide summaries of the essence of each planned worship time to provide guidance to those leading and attending. Our time beginning at 10.45 a.m. on Sundays is designed to be diverse and 'Worship for All'. We have fewer evening acts of worship than in previous years, as this seems to be a time best suited for occasional or special events. So we have a monthly Traditional Worship that includes Holy Communion) and also share with others in our town or region. This year, for a season, we held a weekly 'Beta' series that included small discussion groups. Our weekly 9 a.m. 'Traditional Worship' is short and focused, followed by a simple breakfast. Once a month it incorporates Holy Communion with a more substantial breakfast. During Advent, we devised our own themed services. We celebrated our 45th Anniversary over a glorious weekend in June that included special acts of worship. We also support worship in the middle of the day monthly on Thursdays.

Our children and young people additionally enjoy their own age-appropriate activities each Sunday morning. Worship is normally led by our minister, by other ministers from the Methodist and URC churches, or by (lay) local preachers, sometimes with the assistance of worship leaders.

There are many who contribute to our gathered worship, through playing the organ or instruments in the band, or singing; by preparing and projecting words or images and by providing amplification including a system for use with hearing aids loop; by reading passages of Scripture or leading our prayers; using drama or puppets to present the Scriptures or a message, and by arranging fresh flowers and creating wall decorations. We also recognise the important contribution of all those who welcome people into the building and into our acts of worship, and provide a clean, comfortable and uncluttered building in which to worship.

(b) Teaching and Discipleship

The church is, at its heart, a community of people who have been called together as agents of God's healing and transforming love, professing the good news that Jesus is Lord. It is a group of believers (and explorers) who gather to worship and to encourage each other in the daily living out of their faith – loving and serving God through loving and serving others. Each follower of Christ needs to work out how to do this within their own context, a process which encompasses a lifetime, and so it is of vital importance to offer teaching and practical support in growing as disciples.

The main focus of teaching at Christchurch currently comes within our Sunday morning services and Junior Church sessions. The church asks its preachers to follow the Lectionary plan, so that there is a structured exploration of all parts of the Bible. As mentioned above, during Advent Christchurch devised its own themed services and in autumn 2013 we ran a "whole-church Alpha" course, and 60 adult and youth members and others took part. On the spring of 2014, we followed this up with a "Beta" series looking at specific issues.

There are currently eleven house groups for adults, involving approximately 100 people, who meet regularly to deepen their faith and demonstrate love for God, each other and for the world. Each house group has its own distinctive way of pursuing discipleship. Many house groups read the Bible together, to discuss and to challenge the participants to work out this teaching in practical ways. Others meet to encourage faith development and/or its practical expressions by studying Christian books, undertaking short courses together or initiating various projects. Some house groups meet weekly, some fortnightly, some monthly. All members are encouraged to join such a group, because the church recognises the value of mutual support in this learning. No-one can live out their Christian faith alone.

There is separate, age-specific, support for children and young people (see below)

House groups are just one expression of shared discipleship. There are other groups, such as the Men's Breakfast and informal mutual-accountability partnerships, which develop discipleship in a slightly different way. Prayer, is vital too, and a number of church groups meet to pray together in different ways and for different needs.

The church is conscious of the wide spectrum of people who are a part of our fellowship, and therefore strives to mentor, challenge and support in a range of ways to meet the needs of all. In order to achieve our core purpose as a church, intentional faith development will continue to be a major commitment for us.

Youth & Children's ministry

Discipleship is also the main aim of Youth & Children's ministry; to educate young people about the Bible, enable them to discover more about their faith and equip them to put that into action in their lives.

Our vision for our Youth work is that we long to see every child, teenager and leader seeking to grow more like Jesus by deepening their roots in Christ and bearing fruit in their lives. We hope to see all these roots and fruit growing in the lives of leaders and young people.

We seek to be part of a loving church community that grows:

ROOTS

- A heart for the Gospel
- A passion for worship
- A whole life faith
- A desire to dig deeper into the bible

FRUIT

- Loving and serving our church
- Reaching out in love
- Living 24/7 for Jesus
- Putting others first

Christchurch has a full time Youth & Children's leader who is supported by a strong and large network of volunteers that enable us to deliver our goal vision. We arrange our own training for volunteers and also have access to training events run by groups outside Christchurch. We ensure that all volunteers have the appropriate safeguarding checks in place.

Each week around 60 young people come along to age-specific groups at Junior Church on Sunday mornings. The content of the sessions is usually based on one of the lectionary Bible passages. A variety of methods are used to teach the stories, discussions, dramatised readings, craft activities and songs all contribute to helping the children learn and retain the information about the Bible.

For older teenagers there is also a more in-depth time of study and discussion on a Sunday evening. We look at a key passage from the Bible each week and explore it through conversation and prayer.

In order for Young people to be effectively discipled, it's vital we make sure that what they learn about the Bible is not limited to a set of stories but that what they hear from the Bible also informs and guides them in their everyday lives. At Junior Church we apply the concepts found in a biblical passage to their lives, but there are also other opportunities for young people to learn about their faith through putting it into practice.

The groups we run and support vary from traditional Sunday Junior church to music and puppet groups, Sunday evening youth club, Parent and pre-school groups and uniformed organisations from Beavers and Rainbows, through Brownies and Cubs up to Scouts and Guides. We continue to look at different ways to engage with and involve our children and young people in the life of Christchurch. We run a mentoring programme for our young people to give them support and role models as they develop in their faith.

Over the course of the year we run a number of special events. In the autumn we run a back-to-school family fun day which enables families (churched or not) to spend an afternoon relaxing together and building community. We also run a short residential for our students; from summer 2013, we have had 12 young people away at university, and this is an opportunity for us to equip them for the challenges they face and for them to encourage each other.

In the spring we have our Big Weekend youth residential, where the secondary school groups spend a weekend having fun and talking about Jesus together; we also try to enable the young people themselves to take a lead in organising this event. In the summer we take a group of teenagers to Soul Survivor. Also in the summer, we run a very popular week long holiday club for 5-11s, and support a holiday week on the Isle of Wight (which is run by a group of churches from the town and their schools work team, Phase). All of these events require a team of committed leaders, who are guided, encouraged and enabled by Tom.

(c) Mission and Outreach

Mission and Outreach initiatives and support are under three different headings - Faith Sharing, Home and Overseas. Each section has a co-ordinator who has an overview and supports the work and activities carried out by many different people.

Faith Sharing includes Street Angels, where the Christian faith is shared with those who need support on the streets of our town on a Saturday night; and Alpha courses - helping people to learn more about the Christian faith. We also support special projects where family members of our church are involved. At the present time, we are supporting the work of Jon and Lisa Short, who are working with GBU 'Los Grupos Biblicos Universitarios' in Gran Canaria.

Home covers those community activities which take place in our building [see details below about Open Church, Lunch Club and Computer Club]. An Art space group is held weekly, and is enjoyed by those for whom life is particularly challenging; these people also benefit from the Bancroft [Sunday Lunch] project. We also welcome Parents and Toddlers to various groups and visitors through our weekly Saturday coffee mornings. The church continues to support, in practical and financial ways, local initiatives, such as Simpsons Almshouses, North Herts Sanctuary for the Homeless, and Meeting Needs, which especially helps those setting up home on a limited income. The regular prayer station outside Christchurch offers support in a different way, by praying through people's prayer requests for them, and offering a listening ear if needed. Christchurch has been involved in supporting and providing for the local Food Bank. A new initiative has been the monthly Coffee+ on a Saturday, which provides a family-friendly place for all ages to meet.

Prayer and financial commitment continue to be very much key features of our commitment to serving people overseas. The church continues its support of the Lideta community development project in Ethiopia through the charity World Vision. It is also committed to pray for and financially support brothers and sisters in Christ who face persecution in countries throughout the world through charities such as Open Doors and Barnabas Fund. We also continue to respond throughout the year to emergency appeals as a result of either man-made or natural disasters. A regular Traidcraft stall is held at church at least once a month, promoting awareness of the need for fair and equal trade with developing countries. Through MECO, we offer support to the persecuted church.

(d) Pastoral work

Christchurch endeavours to offer a comprehensive pastoral support network to all who have connections with Christchurch. Pastoral care, including visiting the sick and bereaved, is led and overseen by the Ministry Team who in turn involve area and individual pastoral visitors. House groups and other organizations that are under the Christchurch umbrella also offer pastoral care and support. Pastoral care is offered to those at Archers Court, Elmside and at The Cedars, properties associated with MHA (formerly Methodist Homes for the Aged).

Open church, prayer station and outreach activities within the local community provide companionship to those who wish to talk, be prayed for or be listened to. Individual support is available to the bereaved.

Safeguarding is based on the Methodist Church policy "*Safeguarding Children, Young People and Vulnerable Adults"*. Our safeguarding group is responsible for implementing this policy and ensuring that all users of our premises are aware of the policy and its implications.

(e) Provision of facilities with a Christian ethos for the local community

Facilities with a Christian ethos provided for the local community include Open Church: on 4 weekdays the church is open between 10.00 and 15.00, offering hot/cold drinks and biscuits, as well as a listening ear and a quiet place to pray. It is much appreciated by the homeless and many others.

There is a weekly Lunch Club; around 30 elderly people (referred by Social Services or Age UK) are transported to the church, the majority by minibus, and provided with activities and hospitality as well as lunch.

A Computer Centre is staffed by church members on 2 days per week offering opportunity for anybody wishing to learn and practise skills at operating a computer.

The 'After School Club', run weekly by the Youth Worker and local Christian Schools' Worker, offers to youngsters a range of activities and a place to chat.

(f) Support of other charities in the UK and overseas.

During the year a total of over £14,000 was donated to some 30 other charities in the UK and places abroad including Syria and the Philippines as well as other charities working worldwide. £3,000 was donated from the church's general account, but the bulk of the charitable giving was raised through donations and a variety of methods including coffee mornings, concerts, charity quizzes, social activities and sponsored events, organised by individuals and Groups associated with the church.

Activities shared with others
Christchurch also engages in a range of activities with others including the North Herts Circuit of the Methodist church, the North Herts Group of United Reformed Churches, and with Letchworth Free Church with whom it shares a minister. Christchurch plays a prominent role in Churches Together in Hitchin which organises events such as a Good Friday Walk of Witness, and communication of information throughout the town about Christmas and Easter services at all constituent churches, and also co-ordinates the annual house-to–house collection for Christian Aid.

With other churches in the town Christchurch, supports other community-led initiatives including the North Herts Sanctuary and associated charities, helping the Homeless and those then moving into accommodation.

More detail on the activities of the Charity can be found in the Christchurch Annual Report, which is available on request.

Some statistics
Christchurch had 266 members as at 31 August 2014.

Average attendance at all services on a Sunday was 194, as measured during the month of October 2012, in accordance with the procedures of the Methodist church. This average consisted of 162 adults and 32 under 19s.

Maintenance of the Premises
Maintenance and cleaning of the premises at Christchurch are carried out and monitored by the Finance & Property Committee and the Property Co-ordinator. A Property Schedule has been prepared for forwarding to the Methodist Superintendent, in accordance with Methodist Church procedures.

Apart from the completion of programmes already in place, no major works were initiated in 2013-14 other than renewal of heating equipment. Some interior lighting has been replaced in a number of rooms. Plans are also in place for painting of the exterior timber and some classrooms, and for other electrical works.

During the past twelve months, approximately £40,000 has been spent on cleaning, maintenance and repairs.

Risk Assessment
Each year, the Trustees carry out a Risk Assessment covering a range of risks, including fire, accidents and other Health & Safety matters, finance and staff shortage. Follow-up action is initiated as necessary.

Accounts

The Treasurer has prepared accounts for the year 2013-14, which have been approved, have been audited by an Independent Examiner, and are attached (9 pages) to this report as submitted to the Methodist Church.

The Trustees have also formulated Accounting Policies and a Reserves Policy and these are set out below:

Accounting policies

Incoming Resources

These are included in the Statement of Financial Activities (SOFA) when the church becomes entitled to the resources, the Trustees are virtually certain they will receive the resources and the monetary value can be measured with sufficient reliability.

Resources expended

Expenditure is recognised when a liability is incurred, or a constructive obligation arises that results in the payment being unavoidable.

Liability recognition

Liabilities are recognized as soon as there is a legal or constructive obligation committing the church to payout resources. Future income is not anticipated (in accordance with SORP 2005).

Tangible fixed assets for use by church

Tangible fixed assets are capitalised if they can be used for more than one year, and cost at least £1000. They are valued at cost or a reasonable value on receipt. Where cost is not available, the Trustees have provided a reasonable estimate of cost or of the buildings' current value to the church.

Reserves policy

It is the Trustees' policy to maintain a balance in reserve which equates to 6 months of the assessments due to the Methodist and United Reformed Churches, and wages for the Cleaner and Youth Worker, plus potential employment termination costs and redundancy liabilities. In addition provision has been made for capital projects expected to be carried out during the year.

Further details about the reserves policy are provided in the 2-page attachment following the statement of accounts.

Approved at the Meeting of the Leadership Group on 23 June 2015, and signed on behalf of the Trustees:

David Rossall
Church Secretary

THE METHODIST CHURCH

STANDARD FORM OF ACCOUNTS
ACCRUALS BASIS

for the year ended 31 August 2014

Christchurch Methodist and United Reformed	Church

Registered Charity - Registration number	**1142830**

This will apply to all Charities in Scotland and to all Charities in England and Wales which are Registered Charities.

North Hertfordshire	**Circuit no**	**34/15**

Minister	**Rev. John A Hardaker MA**
Church Stewards	**Dr Peter Ward**
	Mrs Susan Covington
	Mrs Shirley Rossall (until 17 November 2013)
	Mrs Anne Blackman (from 17 November 2013)
Treasurer	**Mr Chris Blackman**

Christchurch Methodist and United Reformed Church

Statement of Financial Activities (SOFA) for the year ended 31 August 2014

	General Fund (Unrestricted) £	Restricted Funds £	Endowment Funds £	Totals this year £	Previous year totals £
Incoming Resources					
1 Offerings and Tax recoverable	121,377	983		122,360	118,518
2 Interest and Investment Income	1,069	134		1,203	1,419
3 Lettings	37,182			37,182	40,062
4 Bequests					30,830
5 Other Income	6,333			6,333	6,305
6 Internal Organisations		45,100		45,100	36,917
7 Total Incoming Resources	165,960	46,217		212,177	234,051
Resources Expended					
8 Circuit Assessment or Share	99,638			99,638	94,852
9 Grants and Donations	4,200			4,200	4,314
10 Repairs and Maintenance	21,959			21,959	28,025
11 Insurance, Utilities etc	12,344			12,344	9,255
12 Depreciation					
13 Provisions					
14 Other expenditure	18,258			18,258	25,425
15 Staff Costs	9,728	28,143		37,872	35,402
16 Internal Organisations		25,177		25,177	16,587
17 Total Resources Expended	166,126	53,320		219,446	213,860
18 Net Incoming Resources	**-166**	**-7,103**		**-7,269**	**20,191**
19 Transfers between funds	-10,759	10,759			
20 Sub Total	**-10,925**	**3,656**		**-7,269**	**20,191**
21 Gains and losses on investment assets					
22 Net investment in funds	-10,925	3,656		-7,269	20,191
23 Total funds brought forward	2,218,408	14,335		2,232,743	2,212,552
24 Total funds carried forward at end of year	**2,207,483**	**17,991**		**2,225,474**	**2,232,743**

For information only: Money received and passed on to External Organisations

Balance brought forward from last year	**225**	
Offerings/Gifts - received for External Organisations	**3,977**	
Offerings/Gifts - passed to External Organisations	**4,202**	
Balance carried forward		

Christchurch Methodist and United Reformed Church

Balance Sheet as at 31 August 2014

	General Fund (Unrestricted) £	Other Funds (Restricted) £	Endowment Funds £	Totals this year £	Totals last year £
Tangible Fixed Assets*					
Church buildings and other property	2,000,000			2,000,000	2,000,000
Investment properties					
Investments					
Total fixed assets	2,000,000			2,000,000	2,000,000
Current Assets					
Debtors and Prepayments	20,756	984		21,740	36,301
Loans by Churches					
Central Finance Board & Trustees for Methodist Church Purposes deposits etc	151,986	12,810		164,796	166,745
Cash at Bank and in hand	35,587	4,197		39,783	30,746
Total current assets	208,329	17,991		226,320	233,792
Creditors and Accruals (due in under 1 year)	846			846	1,049
Net current assets/liabilities	207,483	17,991		225,474	232,743
Total assets less current liabilities	2,207,483	17,991		2,225,474	2,232,743
Loans and creditors due after 1 year					
Provisions for liabilities and charges					
Net assets	**2,207,483**	**17,991**		**2,225,474**	**2,232,743**
Funds of the Church					
General Fund (Unrestricted)	2,207,483			2,207,483	2,218,408
Other Funds (Restricted)		17,991		17,991	14,335
Endowment Funds					
Total Funds	**2,207,483**	**17,991**		**2,225,474**	**2,232,743**

*Details - see page 6

Summary of the Internal Organisations reporting to the Church Council. Note that the funds of an Internal Organisation would normally be Restricted funds unless it could be clearly shown that they could be used for any Methodist purpose.

Internal Organisations		Opening balances	Receipts	Payments	Net Receipts/ payments	Adjustments	Closing balances
e1	Lunch Club	3015	7712	7406	3321		3321
e2	Youth	915	26886	32139	-4338	10420	6082
e3	Geoff Milledge	4766	32		4798		4798
e4	Pastoral Care	1101	1169	1089	1181	339	1520
e5	Senior Badminton	240	587	36	791		791
e6	Ladies Friendship Circle	206	775	917	64		64
e7	Lideta	38	3179	3216	1		1
e8	Junior Church	1699	2209	2517	1391		1391
e9	Shorts Mission	2355	3668	6000	23		23
	Total	14335	46217	53320	7232	10759	17991

Total Receipts	Total Payments

Continue on a separate sheet if necessary and bring the totals forward Transfer totals of Receipts and Payments to the SOFA

Notes to the Accounts

1 Basis of accounting

These accounts have been prepared on the basis of historic cost (except that investments are shown at market value) in accordance with Statement of Recommended Practice (SORP 2005) and the Charities Act 2011. There has been no change to the accounting policies since last year. The format of the SOFA balance sheet takes advantage of the small charity concessions set out in the SORP.

2 Funds

The funds held constitute: General Funds held for any purpose of the charity which are Unrestricted, Restricted funds which are held for a narrower purpose and Endowment funds which represent gifts, the capital normally being unavailable for spending, and the income from which is either Restricted or Unrestricted. Details of each material fund are disclosed in the final Note to these Accounts. Any fund may be held in ways other than in cash.

3 Accounting policies

Incoming Resources

These are included in the Statement of Financial Activities (SOFA) when the church becomes entitled to the resources, the trustees are virtually certain they will receive the resources, and the monetary value can be measured with sufficient reliability.

Resources Expended

Expenditure is recognised when a liability is incurred, or a constructive obligation arises that results in the payment being unavoidable.

Liability recognition

Liabilities are recognised as soon as there is a legal or constructive obligation committing the church to pay out resources. Future income has not been anticipated (SORP 2005).

Tangible fixed assets for use by church

Tangible fixed assets are capitalised if they can be used for more than one year, and cost at least £1000. They are valued at cost or a reasonable value on receipt. Where cost is not available, the Church Council may provide a reasonable estimate of cost or of the buildings' current value to the church. An estimate based on insurance value should take account of the fact that cover will be based on demolition and reinstating the current building and not the original cost less accumulated depreciation. A professional valuation is not required, but if available use that figure. Provision is made for depreciation where appropriate.

Investment properties

This includes Investment properties which are not used for the purposes of the charity (and never used for that purpose). A professional valuation is not required, but if available use that figure. The insured value may be used.

Investments

Investments are valued in the balance sheet at market value at the year end. Investment income is included in the accounts when receivable and any gains or losses on revaluation at the year end are shown in the SOFA.

Include investments held with the Central Finance Board. Do not include Deposit Funds, such as TIF (Trustees Interest Fund) held via Trustees for Methodist Church Purposes. These latter funds should be shown separately.

Debtors and Prepayments

These amounts are owed to the Church and include payments made by the Church for services yet to be received.

Creditors

These amounts are owed by the Church and include any amounts accrued as payable this year but will be paid in future years.

Loans

If the Church has borrowed any money, please give the information in the designated section. Loans made to Churches may be confidential and may be free of interest. It is not necessary to breach confidentiality in recording sources: use the word 'Individuals' if appropriate.

Endowment Funds

Where the Church holds money which cannot be spent but must be retained (as capital) to generate an income the money or assets to be retained are known as an Endowment Fund. The capital should be shown in the appropriate column in the Balance Sheet. The income generated may be restricted or unrestricted depending upon the terms of the endowment.

Net current assets/liabilities

Deduct Creditors from Total current assets.

Total assets less net current liabilities

Deduct net current assets/liabilities from the total of fixed and current assets.

Net assets totals must agree with Total Funds held.

4 Payment to Trustees

		This year	Last year
Payments made to trustees for additional services provided to the Church by agreement with the Church Council.Payments to trustees include,for example, a trustee who is also a plumber and who carries out work in that capacity. (More detailed guidance is on the Methodist website)	£		
Number of trustees who were paid expenses			

Nature of the expenses

Total amount paid	£		

5 Fees for examination or audit of the accounts

Independent examiner's or auditor's fees for reporting on the accounts	£	546	525
Other fees (eg: advice, accountancy services) paid to the independent examiner or auditor	£		

6 Paid employees

Staff Costs paid during the year were:

Gross wages, salaries and benefits in kind	£	34,122	36,637
Employer's National Insurance costs	£	2,524	2,483
Pension costs	£	1,225	1,225
Total staff costs	£	37,871	40,345
Average number of full-time equivalent employees in the year were:		2	2

7 Capital Commitments and Contingent Liabilities

If the Church has any commitments or liabilities these should be disclosed

At the 31st August 2014 capital commitments amounted to:	£		
Contingent liabilities amounted to:	£		

Christchurch Methodist and United Reformed Church

Tangible Fixed Assets

Cost or valuation

	Church buildings and other property	Other land & buildings	Other fixed assets, including motor vehicles	Fixtures, fittings and equipment	Payments on account and assets under construction	Total
	£	£	£	£	£	
Balance brought forward	2,000,000					2,000,000
Additions						
Revaluations						
Disposals						
Transfers *						
Balance carried forward	2,000,000					2,000,000

Accumulated depreciation

**Basis	SL or RB	SL or RB	SL or RB	SL or RB	SL or RB	
** Rate						
Balance brought forward						
Depreciation charge for year						
Revaluations						
Disposals						
Transfers*						
Balance carried forward						

Net book value

Brought forward	2,000,000					2,000,000
Carried forward	2,000,000					2,000,000

* The "transfers" row is for movements between fixed asset categories.

** Indicate the method of depreciation by deleting the method not applicable (SL = straight line; RB = reducing balance). Also indicate the rate of depreciation: for straight line, depreciation is based on the anticipated life of the asset (in years); for reducing balance, a percentage annual deduction is made each year.

Investment assets

	Market value at year end	Income from investments for year
	£	£
Investment properties		

Analysis of investments

Investments listed on a recognised Stock Exchange or held in common investment funds, open ended investment companies, unit trusts or other collective investment schemes		
Securities not listed on a recognised Stock Exchange		
Cash held as part of the investment portfolio		
Other investments		
Total		

Change in investment values

Carrying (market) value at beginning of year	
Add: additions to investments at cost	
Less: disposals at carrying value	
Add/(deduct): net gain/(loss) on revaluation (This should agree with Line 21 in the SOFA)	
Carrying (market) value at end of year	

Loans

Christchurch Methodist and United Reformed Church

Source	Purpose of loan	Amount brought forward	New borrowings	Loan interest	Repayable in the year	Balance at year end
	Totals					x

Repayment due by

									Totals
Due within 12 months	31/08/2015								
Due between 1 and 5 years	31/08/2016		31/08/2017		31/08/2018		31/08/2019		
Due later than 5 years									
Note: the two totals X and Y must agree									y

Endowment Funds

Endowment Name	How the capital is invested	The current value of the capital	Annual income	What the income was used for
	Totals			

Restricted Funds

Restricted Fund Name	Opening Balance	Incoming Resources	Resources Expended	Transfers	Closing Balance	Purpose of the fund
Totals						

The reasons for the transfers between funds were as follows:

DECLARATIONS

Treasurer

I confirm that I have prepared the accounts from the records of the Church and that they include all funds under the control of the Church Council Known as the Leadership Group

Signature of Treasurer [signature] Date 22.05.15

Name CHRIS BLACKMAN

Address 3 BENSLOW RISE
HITCHIN, HERTS SG4 9QX

Presentation to the *Church Council for approval.

I confirm that the Accounts have been ~~or will be (*)~~ presented to the Church Council on 20.05.15
and were ~~or will be (*)~~ approved on 20.05.15

Signature of the Chair of the meeting [signature]

Name of the Chair of the meeting JOHN A HARDAKER

Date 24.05.15

Independent Examiner's Report to the Trustees of the

Christchurch (Methodist/URC) Church

This Report is on the Church Accounts for the year ended 31st August 2014

Respective responsibilities of Trustees and Examiner

The charity's trustees are responsible for the preparation of the accounts. The charity's trustees consider that an audit is not required for this year under section 144 of the Charities Act 2011 (the Charities Act) and that an independent examination is needed.

It is my responsibility to:

- Examine the accounts under Section 145 of the Charities Act
- to follow the procedures laid down in the general Directions given by the Charity Commission (under Section 145(5)(b) of the Charities Act), and
- to state whether particular matters have come to my attention.

Basis of Independent Examiner's Report

My examination was carried out in accordance with general Directions given by the Charity Commission. An examination includes a review of the accounting records kept by the charity and a comparison of the accounts presented with those records. It also includes consideration of any unusual items or disclosures in the accounts, and seeking explanations from the trustees concerning any such matters. The procedures undertaken do not provide all the evidence that would be required in an audit, and consequently no opinion is given as to whether the accounts present a 'true and fair' view and the report is limited to those matters set out in the statement below.

Independent Examiner's Statement

In connection with my examination, no matter has come to my attention (other than that disclosed below*):

(1) which gives me reasonable cause to believe that in any material respect the

- to keep accounting records in accordance with section 130 of the Charities Act;
- to prepare accounts which accord with the accounting records and comply with the accounting requirements of the Charities Act have not been met;

(2) to which, in my opinion, attention should be drawn in order to enable a proper understanding of the accounts to be reached.

(3) I have obtained direct verification of the cash balances (e.g Bank,CFB,TMCP) from the holders of those monies.

** Please delete the words in the brackets if they do not apply appropriate*

Name: N. C. HARDING FCA

Signature: Neil Harding

Relevant Professional qualification or body: ICAEW

Address: CROFT CHAMBERS, 11 BANCROFT HITCHIN, HERTS SG5 1JQ

Date: 4-6-15

RESERVES POLICY

Report on behalf of Christchurch Hitchin

(*Church Council/ Circuit Meeting/District)

To North Hertfordshire Circuit

(*Circuit Meeting/District/Resourcing Mission Office)

We submit our annual report in accordance with the requirements of the Methodist Conference and the Charities SORP.

(I) The trustees have established their mission aims taking into account all of the resources available in terms of people, property and money

(ii) Mission initiatives/projects have been costed or estimates made of projected future costs which take into account the needs of the buildings and the requirements of the Quinquennial Inspection Report/s

(iii) We have agreed a Reserves Policy which is set out overleaf and is recorded in the trustees' minutes and our Annual Report

(iv) We recognise the need to be accountable as charity trustees for all the money which comes into our hands and will provide further information as required by the Circuit/District/Connexion

(v) Our Report is attached overleaf →

* please delete as appropriate

To be completed by Receiving Body

The _____

*Circuit Meeting/District/Resourcing Mission Office received the RESERVES POLICY of

_____

*Church Council/Circuit Meeting/District

Policy accepted and acknowledgement sent to the trustees YES☐/NO☐

Policy noted and the following enquiries made of the trustees

Responses received and any further action taken

***Circuit/District/Resourcing Mission Office**

Signatures …… …… **Date**……

* Please delete as appropriate

RESERVES POLICY of **Christchurch Hitchin**

(*Church Council☒/Circuit Meeting☐/District☐)

1.	**General** Funds held at Y/E 31/08/2014	£**207,483**

2.	**Restricted** Funds held "	£**17,991**

3.	**Endowment** Funds held "	£**0**

4. **Reserves policy for General Funds**

£26,500 Methodist Circuit Assessment (6 months)
£27,500 United Reformed Church Assessment (6 months)
£ 5,000 Lay Employee (Cleaner)
£20,000 Youth Worker Project Support [see below]

£12,000 Potential employment termination costs and redundancy liabilities - (The cleaner's termination costs would be £7,300; and the Youth Worker's termination costs would be £4,700

Funds are currently needed for following projects
£3,000 Refurbishment and development of Outside Shed used for storage
£2,000 Safety improvements in church garden used by creche and playgroups
up to £30,000 Development of building alterations for access to an enhanced garden area

Also, following recent Quinquennial review:
£35,000 to meet recommendations of report - including roof maintenance and repairs

5. **Policy for Restricted Funds**

The Geoff Milledge Fund is a Restricted Fund to be used for the advancement of Young people entering a missionary vocation and to assist in their travel, training and development at home and overseas. The fund stands at £4,798.

The Youth Worker Project: The URC has approved a grant over 5 years in reponse to an application for development of Youth Ministry; this is subject to matching support from the Methodist Church. The church anticipates providing £20,000 in 2014-15 from general funds to the Youth Worker Project in addition to £10,000 contributed directly by members. As of August 2014 the Youth Worker Fund stands at £6,082.

The Pastoral Fund is controlled by the Minister and Deacon and stands at £1,519.

6. **Terms relating to Endowment Funds held**

Whilst there are no endowment funds as such, the church has received in the last 3 years as many as four bequests totalling £75k. This money, which is included in the General Funds of £166k quoted above, is not restricted but is seen as available for use towards plans for developing the building and the adjacent garden to make it more accessible for developing Youth Work and other activities.

This Reserves Policy has been approved by **The Trustees of Christchurch Hitchin**

(*Church Council☐/Circuit Meeting☐/District☐)

Treasurer	Trustee
Full name	Full Name
Signature	Signature